CHAPTER 2

LEARNING THE BASICS

Before beginning the tasks in this chapter, you'll find it helpful to read "Before You Begin." It contains important information that will make it easier for you to learn and practice the basics of word processing with WordStar.

In this chapter you'll learn how to

- Start WordStar
- Create a File
- Edit a Document
- Name and Save a File
- Print a File

When you finish this chapter, you'll be ready to apply these skills to your own tasks.

STARTING WORDSTAR

In word processing, each document is kept in a file on a disk. You'll follow the same steps each time you write or edit with WordStar.

To start WordStar:

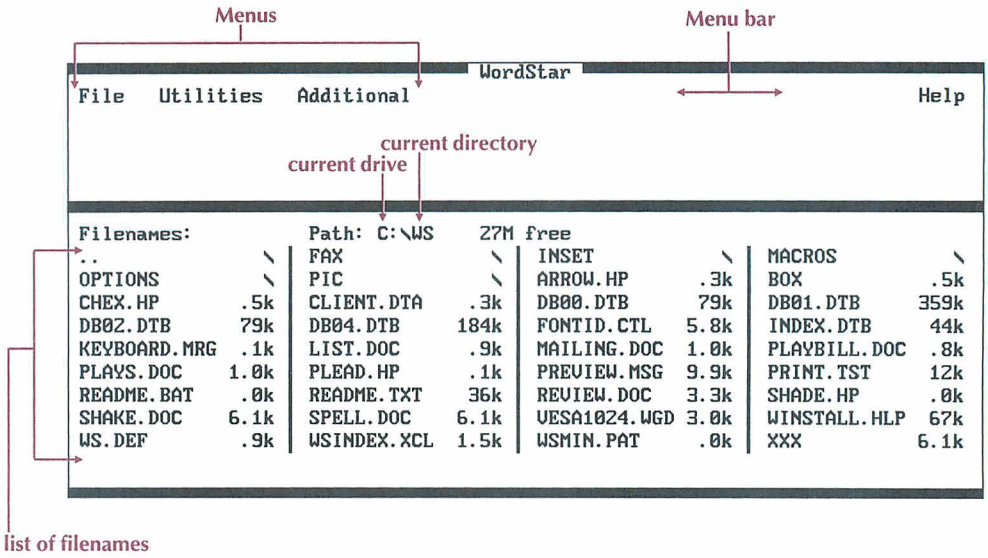
1. Look at the DOS prompt to be sure you're in the directory that contains your WordStar program files (usually WS). If you're not, type **cd\ws** and press the Enter key. (If you copied your WordStar program files to another directory during installation, type **cd** and the name of that directory and press Enter.)

2. Type **ws** and press Enter.

When you are using WordStar, onscreen help is always available. To get immediate help with what you're doing, press the F1 key.

THE OPENING SCREEN

Each time you start WordStar, you see the Opening screen.



The menu bar contains the names of the menus you can choose—File, Utilities, Additional, and Help. Each menu lists commands for performing word processing tasks. To perform a task, you choose a menu and then choose the command that will perform the task.

Also on the Opening screen is a directory of filenames. This directory lists the files contained in the current directory on the current drive.

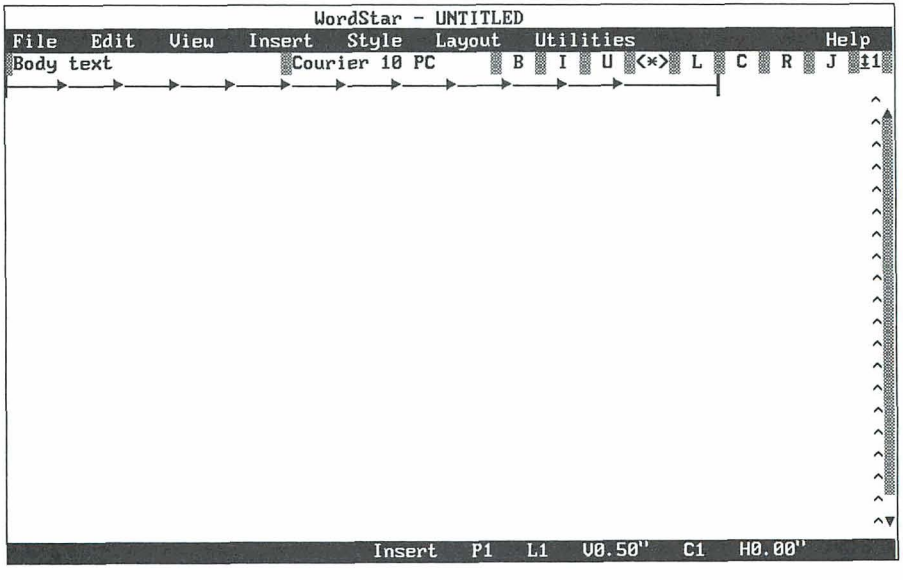
CREATING A FILE

In this chapter, you open a new file, type some text, and then practice editing. To create a file, first choose the File menu from the Opening screen. Then, from the File menu, you can create a file.

Note: In the following steps, the arrow symbol (→) points to the next item you should choose on a pull-down menu or in a dialog box. For example, File→New means choose the File menu and then choose the New command.

1. At the Opening screen choose File→New or press (F,W) to open a new file.

2. Notice that WordStar displays the Editing screen.



The menu bar at the top of the screen contains other menus from which you can select word processing tasks.

TYPING TEXT

When the Editing screen appears, you're ready to type. Before you begin, you need to know a few things about word processing.

- The cursor marks your place in the text so you always know where you are typing on the page.
- You can move the cursor by pressing the direction keys. The direction keys include the arrow keys, the PgUp and PgDn keys, and the Home and End keys.
- When you come to the end of a line, WordStar automatically *wraps* the text to the next line.
- Press the Enter key twice to start a new paragraph. If you press Enter by mistake, just press the Backspace key. The cursor moves back to the previous location.

Now type the following text. (Line lengths may not be the same on your screen.)

```
Tryouts for "The Merry Wives of Windsor" will begin on
Thursday.  If you're interested in reading for one of the
principal roles, please sign your name on the sheet posted
backstage.  No guest actors have been signed for the
production, so all roles will be filled by members of the
company.

"Merry Wives" will be the tenth anniversary season opener
for the Theatre in the Park series and will be staged at
MacPherson Park Amphitheater.  The production is
underwritten by the Morris Corporation, and all proceeds
will go to the Boys and Girls Clubs.  Club members will be
admitted free.  Following the performance, a fund-raising
gala will be held at the Pavilion, and members of the cast
and crew will be honored guests.
```

```
This open-air production presents extra challenges such as
uncertain weather conditions and background noise, but
similar productions in the past have been received
enthusiastically by audiences and reviewers.
```

You'll use the text you typed in the remaining sections of this chapter. If you made any typing errors, you can correct them later when you learn editing skills. If you've made so many errors that you want to start over, choose File→Close (Alt+F,C) at the Editing screen. At the Close File dialog box, press A. WordStar returns you to the Opening screen where you can start again.

EDITING A FILE

You've now learned how to start WordStar, create a file, and type text. But the real power of word processing is editing. With the WordStar editing commands, you can correct typos, change wording, insert or delete words, and much more.

MOVING AROUND IN A DOCUMENT

In "Before you Begin" you learned that WordStar has several different ways to move the cursor in a document. One way is to use the WordStar cursor diamond commands below. (Hold down the Ctrl key and press the letter.)

- ^D (moves the cursor right one character)
- ^S (moves the cursor left one character)
- ^F (moves the cursor right one word)
- ^A (moves the cursor left one word)

Remember, you can also move the cursor by pressing any of the direction keys.

In addition to using the cursor diamond or the direction keys, you can make quick moves in your document by using the Go to Other command on the Edit menu.

To practice moving around in your document, follow the steps below. The "Merry Wives" file should be displaying on your screen.

1 Choose Edit→Go to Other→Document Beginning (Alt+E,O,D) to move the cursor back to the beginning of the document.

   You can use the shortcut ^End to move to the end of a document.

2 Choose Edit→Go to Other→Document End (Alt+E,O,O) to move the cursor to the end of the document.

   You can also use the shortcut ^Home to move to the beginning of a document.

TIP *If you are editing a long document, you can press P at the Edit Menu (or click Go to Page) and enter a page number. WordStar moves the cursor to the top of the page you request.*

INSERTING TEXT

Before inserting text, look at the status line at the bottom of the screen to see if Insert mode is on or off. You'll see *Insert* or *Ins-off*. When Insert is on, text is inserted at the cursor location. When Insert is off, text is typed directly over existing text. WordStar comes with Insert on. To turn Insert off or back on, press the Insert key. Insert should be on to complete the following steps.

1 In the second paragraph of the "Merry Wives" text, move the cursor to the "a" in "anniversary" and type **annual** and press the Spacebar once.

2 Move the cursor to the end of the document. Press Enter twice to start a new paragraph, and type **Plan now to attend.**

DELETING TEXT

You can delete individual characters and words or entire lines in WordStar. To delete a character, press the Del or Backspace key. To delete a word or a line, follow these steps:

Deleting a word

1 Move the cursor to the "a" in "annual."

2 Choose Edit→Delete→Word (Alt+E,D,W).

The word "annual" is deleted.

Deleting a line

1 Move the cursor to the last line of the text.

2 Choose Edit→Delete→Line (Alt+E,D,L).

The line of text is erased.

You've probably noticed that classic menu commands appear on the pull-down menus. A few classic commands provide shortcuts. Two of these shortcuts are ^T (delete a word) and ^Y (delete a line). If you prefer, you can use the classic commands. Classic commands generally take fewer keystrokes than pull-down commands.

Restoring text

Another handy feature of WordStar is the Undo command. It restores text that you delete by mistake. To see how it works, delete a line of text and then restore it.

1 Move the cursor to the beginning of the third paragraph.

2 This time press the shortcut classic command ^Y to delete the line.

3 Choose Edit→Undo (Alt+E,U) to restore the line.

The deleted line is back in the text. Single characters erased with the Del key or the Backspace key cannot be restored with Undo.

TIP *You can also restore text with the shortcut classic command ^U.*

MOVING TEXT

Moving text in a document is easy when you mark the text as a block.

MARKING A BLOCK OF TEXT

First you mark the beginning and the end of the text you want to move.

1. Move the cursor to the first word in the document "Merry Wives."
2. Choose Edit→Mark Block Beginning (Alt+E,B).
3. Move the cursor to the end of the first paragraph.
4. Choose Edit→Mark Block End (Alt+E,E).

   The block of text is highlighted.

MOVING A BLOCK OF TEXT

Now you can move the text to a different place in the document.

1. Move the cursor to the end of the document.
2. Choose Edit→Move→Block (Alt+E,V,B) to move the block.

   The entire paragraph moves to the new location.
3. Move the cursor to the beginning of the document where the paragraph was originally located.
4. Repeat step 2 to move the paragraph back to its original location.

REMOVING THE BLOCK HIGHLIGHTING

You can remove the highlighting from a block of text by following these steps:

1. Choose View→Block Highlighting (Alt+V,B).
2. Notice that the block of text is no longer highlighted.

ADDING BOLD EMPHASIS

You can add special printing effects, such as bold or italic, to text.

1. In the first paragraph of the "Merry Wives" text, move the cursor to the first quotation mark in "The Merry Wives of Windsor."

2. Choose Style→Bold (Alt+S,B) to begin bold.

3. Move the cursor to the space following the second quotation mark and repeat step 2. The entire title is now bold.

VIEWING COMMAND TAGS

When you tell WordStar to insert a special printing effect, command tags appear on the screen where you turn the special effect on and off. For example, when you add bold to text, the WordStar command tag ^B appears on either side of the bold text. You can turn the command tags display off so you can see more clearly what your document looks like.

1. Choose View→Command Tags (Alt+V,C).

   Notice that the print command tags are no longer visible; however, the commands are still in effect.

   TIP *You can use the shortcut classic command ^OD to turn the command tags display on or off.*

2. Repeat step 1, or use ^OD, to turn the command tags display back on.

NAMING AND SAVING A DOCUMENT

When you create a new document with File→New (F,W), you give the file a name when you save it. Once a file is named and saved, you can retrieve it at any time to read or edit it.

A filename can contain from one to eight characters, including letters and numbers. You can also add a filename extension to the eight-character name. A file extension is a period followed by three characters.

Now name and save your "Merry Wives" document.

1 Choose File→Save and Close (Alt+F,L).

The Save As dialog box appears.

2 Type **notice.doc** in the Filename box.

3 Press F10 or choose OK to close the dialog box.

You have typed, edited, named, and saved the document.

The filename NOTICE.DOC is now listed in the directory display.

TIP When you create a filename, think of a name that will remind you of the contents of your document. For example, if you are writing a letter to a client named Smith, you might name your file SMITHLTR. The extension could be a date reminder. If you wrote the letter on June 16, the entire filename could be SMITHLTR.616. You can use the numbers 1–9 for January through September and the letters O, N, and D for October, November, and December.

PRINTING A DOCUMENT

If you have installed a printer, you can print your document. Now you'll print NOTICE.DOC.

1 At the Opening screen, choose File→Print (F,P).

The Print dialog box appears. This is where you tell the printer what to print and how to print it. Most of the time you won't need to change any of the information shown.

```
                              Print
Filename: C:\WS\NOTICE.DOC                                  OK

Page Numbers:                                   Pages:      Cancel
          ◆ All                                  o Odd
          o Selected Pages:                      o Even
            A                                    ◆ Both

Copies: 1

                                                [X] Use Form Feeds
Printer: HPLASER                                [ ] Pause Between Pages
                                                [ ] Print Unformatted Text
Redirect To:                                    [X] Interpret Merge Variables
```

NOTICE.DOC is the file you just saved and want to print.

2 Press F10 or choose OK to begin printing the file.

OPENING AN EXISTING FILE

To open the NOTICE.DOC file, follow these steps:

1 At the Opening screen choose File→Open Document (F,D).

The Open dialog box appears.

2 Type **notice.doc** and press F10 or choose OK. You see the **NOTICE.DOC** file on the Editing screen.

TIP *Besides typing the name of the file that you want to open, you can select the file in other ways. If you have a mouse, click on the filename in the list of files. Or use the direction keys to move the cursor to the filename and press Enter.*

3 Choose File→Save and Close (Alt+F,L) to save any editing changes and close the file.

REVIEWING THE BASICS

You've covered the basics of word processing. For most word processing tasks you follow these steps:

1. Start WordStar.
2. Create or open a file.
3. Type or edit text.
4. Name and save the file.
5. Print the file.

Now you are ready to move on to the next chapter and learn how to format your documents. If you want to stop here and leave WordStar, choose File→Exit WordStar (F,X).